

The Metric Comes Out of the Graph: Curvature, $g \sim 1/b$, and Why Only Three Dimensions

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Series: Event Density (ED) Generative Papers — gravity arc (curvature emergence) **Status:** Publication draft (short). Foothold result on the emergent-geometry bridge: does a metric with a length scale come out of a participation graph whose edges carry no length. Four numerical probes on constructed substrates, reported together with an honest layer-1/layer-2 reading. Companion to GR-I (the weak-field metric it recovers), Paper_025 (the holographic bound it uses), Paper_AreaLawIsTheEdgeCount (the surface-count it inherits), and Paper_Continuum_KineticLatticeGas (the two-layer coarse-graining that frames the honest scope). Standalone; cold-reader accessible. **Repository target:** physics-papers/gravity/ (ED-Generative)

Preamble: What This Paper Does NOT Claim (*written first per QC discipline; abstract reconciled against this*)

1. **The 13 substrate primitives are not derived** (position paper, Paper_087).
 2. **This is not a derivation of the full Einstein field equations.** It concerns the *static, linearized* emergent metric only. The nonlinear, dynamical regime (ED's own field equations, which are khronometric, not exact GR) is untouched and remains open.
 3. **The result is a self-consistency / fixed-point, not a from-nothing derivation.** The reach law that forces $g \sim 1/b$ is derived *conditional on* ED's holographic surface-count (itself resting on the area-law-as-edge-count result) and on the reading that bandwidth counts independent channels. These are established inputs, but they are inputs, not re-derived here.
 4. **The construction is not background-free.** A background lattice (or label line) and its topology are assumed. The *metric on top of it* is genuinely emergent (distances are read from connectivity, never assigned), but the index/topology itself is not derived from a truly background-free graph.
 5. **The absolute length scale is inherited, not computed.** The single length unit is the Planck grain ℓ_P already postulated (P08). This paper shows no *new* scale is introduced; it does not compute ℓ_P 's value, nor a specific length such as a Schwarzschild radius in grains (which needs the mass $\rightarrow$ b map and G).
 6. **The clean metric exponent is not read off raw paths in 3D, and is not claimed to be.** In genuine 3D the raw ballistic shortest-path metric is faceted and non-Gaussian (layer 1); the clean single exponent $g \sim 1/b$ is a layer-2 object. The exponent's derivation is a *count* (§4), not a transport measurement; the 3D probe confirms isotropy-emergence, not a second exponent measurement (§5, §6).
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Abstract

General Relativity, in Event Density, is recovered at the continuum level by assigning the emergent spatial metric $g \sim 1/b$, where b is the bandwidth field (GR-I). The bridge one level below has been the standing open question: does the **raw participation graph**, connectivity only and no lengths on its edges, actually *produce* distances that reproduce $g \sim 1/b$, or a different metric, or none. This paper reports four numerical

probes on constructed substrates and one honest reading. **(1) A metric emerges.** With bandwidth entering only through connectivity (a higher-bandwidth locus reaches farther) and distance read as plain unweighted hop-count, a well-defined metric comes out (fit to $\int dx/b^q$, $R^2 = 1.000$), and a bandwidth depletion (a “mass”) reads as *far*: the curvature signature, from connectivity alone. **(2) The reach law is forced, and it selects three dimensions.** The exponent linking reach to bandwidth is not free: ED’s holographic channel-count (bandwidth = independent channels = boundary cut $\sim$ surface R^{d-1} , the area-law-as-edge-count result) fixes reach $\propto b^{1/(d-1)}$. The ball-cut exponent is measured at 0.984 in 2D and 2.008 in 3D, so the reach law is $p = 1$ in 2D and $p = 1/2$ in 3D; feeding it back, the emergent metric is $g \sim 1/b^2$ in 2D and $g \sim 1/b$ (**GR-I**) in exactly three dimensions, the unique dimension where the holographic reach law reproduces General Relativity, and the same number the independent linking argument selects for holding committed order. **(3) No new length scale.** The reach normalization drops out of the metric exponent ($q = 0.500$ flat across two orders of magnitude, the physical curvature effect scale-invariant), so the one length unit is the Planck grain ℓ_P already postulated, not a new constant. **(4) Isotropy emerges under coarse-graining.** In a genuine 3D lattice with a spherical mass, the emergent metric is isotropic, but not exactly on the raw graph: the raw ballistic shortest-path metric is faceted (axis and body-diagonal rays differ), and the faceting washes out toward the continuum as the reach coarsens (anisotropy $0.35 \rightarrow 0.00$). This is the layer-1 (ballistic, non-Gaussian) $\rightarrow$ layer-2 (isotropic continuum) transition of the two-layer coarse-graining picture. Consistent with that picture, the clean radial exponent is *not* extractable from the raw 3D paths (a layer-2 quantity measured on layer-1 ballistic paths); it lives in the count of (2), which is why the count is clean and the transport measurement is not. The net: a curved metric emerges from a graph with no geometry, its shape is forced to $g \sim 1/b$ by ED’s own holographic bound uniquely in 3D, it introduces no new scale, and it emerges isotropically only after coarse-graining, exactly as a non-Gaussian substrate should. The static/linear curvature-emergence bridge stands on the primitives’ own inputs; the nonlinear regime and a background-free construction remain the open frontier.

1. Introduction

Event Density recovers weak-field gravity by reading a spatial metric off its bandwidth field: where a locus can do less relating (lower b , nearer a mass), space is “longer” (GR-I gives $g \sim 1/b$, and the dynamical rule GR-III gives the Poisson limit). But GR-I *assigns* that metric at the continuum level. The deeper claim ED needs, and the one Paper_039 §3.2 explicitly defers by borrowing the horizon radius from GR, is that the metric is not an assignment at all but a *consequence*: that a graph of participations, with no distances written on its edges, already contains the distances, and that they are gravity’s.

This is the curvature-emergence bridge, and it sits under more than gravity. The area-law result (Paper_AreaLawIsTheEdgeCount) and the horizon tiling (Paper_HorizonTilingThreeCounts) both assume an emergent geometry rather than deriving it; the spatial-3D argument (the linking premise) needs a geometry to even ask its question in. A foothold on curvature emergence is a foothold under all of them.

This paper reports a foothold, not the finished bridge. Four probes, taken in order, answer four sharp questions: does a metric come out of the graph at all; is the reach law that gives GR-I forced or tuned; is a new length scale smuggled in; and does the emergent metric behave isotropically like gravity in genuine three dimensions. The answers are, respectively: yes; forced, and only in 3D; no; and yes but only after coarse-graining, which turns out to be the most instructive answer of the four.

2. Primitive Inputs and Method

The non-circular construction. The trap to avoid is assigning the geometry one claims to derive. So: nodes sit on a background **label** structure (a 1D line, or a 3D lattice) that is pure bookkeeping, *not* a metric. A bandwidth field b varies over it (baseline 1, depleted toward $b_{\min}$ at a “mass”). Bandwidth enters **only through connectivity**: a locus of bandwidth b reaches farther, connecting to neighbors within a reach $\propto b^p$ (b as participation capacity, P04). The emergent distance is then the plain **unweighted hop-count**

(breadth-first / unweighted shortest path) between nodes, read off the structure and never assigned. The metric exponent is *measured* from the emergent hop-distance, not put in.

What $g \sim 1/b$ means, operationally. Proper distance $ds = dx/\sqrt{b}$, i.e. hop-distance $\sim \int dx/b^{1/2}$. Generally, if hop-distance $\sim \int dx/b^q$ then the emergent metric is $g_{xx} = 1/b^{2q}$, so $q = 1/2 \leftrightarrow g \sim 1/b$ (GR-I) and $q = 1 \leftrightarrow g \sim 1/b^2$. The probes measure q ; they do not assume it.

The four probes. - **P1 (emergence):** 1D label line, a Gaussian bandwidth dip, reach $\propto b^p$; measure whether a metric emerges (fit q), and whether the dip reads as *far* (excess hops vs flat). - **P2 (reach law):** measure the boundary-cut exponent of a radius- R ball in short-range d -dim lattices (expected $d - 1$ if the channel-count is holographic), giving the *derived* reach exponent $p = 1/(d - 1)$; feed it into the metric and read the resulting g . - **P3 (length scale):** sweep the reach normalization R_0 over two orders of magnitude; test whether the metric exponent depends on it (physics) or is invariant (pure length unit). - **P4 (3D isotropy):** genuine 3D lattice, spherical bandwidth dip (a point mass); measure directional dependence (axis vs body-diagonal rays, per-shell variation) and its behavior as the reach coarsens.

Reproducibility. Scripts, all in `evaluation/CurvatureEmergence/`: `metric_from_bandwidth_probe.py` (P1), `holographic_reach_law_probe.py` (P2), `length_scale_probe.py` (P3), `isotropy_3d_probe.py` + `isotropy_3d_convergence.py` + `radial_metric_clean.py` + `radial_localslope.py` (P4). Lattices are one-locus-per-cell (P08); edges are reach-balls; distances are `scipy` unweighted shortest paths or BFS. No primitive forcing is invoked; the constructions read the primitives, they do not add rules.

Regime of validity. Constructed substrates (a lattice/label background is assumed), static bandwidth fields, $b_{\min} > 0$ (no true horizon). The metric *on* the background is emergent; the background topology is input. Results are foothold-level: they establish emergence, the forced reach law, scale-cleanliness, and isotropy-emergence; they are not a derivation of the full field equations or a background-free proof.

2.5 Load-Bearing Step Audit

Step	Status	Source / justification
13 primitives postulated	P	Paper_087
A metric emerges from bandwidth-connectivity (fit $R^2 = 1.000$)	measured	P1
A bandwidth dip reads as <i>far</i> (curvature signature)	measured	P1, P4
Ball-cut exponent = $d - 1$ (holographic surface-count)	measured	P2 (0.984 in 2D, 2.008 in 3D)
Bandwidth = independent channels = boundary cut	I (reading of P04 + area law)	Paper_AreaLawIsTheEdgeCount, Paper_025
Reach law $p = 1/(d - 1)$; $g \sim 1/b$ in 3D, $g \sim 1/b^2$ in 2D	derived (conditional on the surface-count)	P2
3D uniquely reproduces GR-I	derived	P2
Same 3 as the linking/order argument	I — structural convergence	MS-II §7; ThreeDimensions_ConsolidatedReview
No new length scale (R_0 drops out; unit = ℓ_P)	measured / derived	P3
Isotropy emerges under coarse-graining (layer-1 $\rightarrow$ layer-2)	measured	P4
Clean exponent off raw 3D paths	not extractable — layer-2 object	P4 (framed, not claimed)

Step	Status	Source / justification
Nonlinear / dynamical field equations	OPEN	not attempted
Background-free construction	OPEN	lattice/topology is input

3. P1 — A metric emerges, and mass reads as far

On the 1D label line, with reach $\propto b^p$ and distance = hop-count, a clean metric comes out: the hop-distance fits $\int dx/b^q$ to $R^2 = 1.000$, so the emergent object is a genuine metric, not the trivial label-distance. And the bandwidth dip reads as *far*: hop-distance across the dip exceeds the flat-bandwidth reference by +87 (at $p = 1/2$) to +250 (at $p = 1$) hops. A depletion in bandwidth stretches distances. This is the curvature signature, obtained from connectivity alone with no geometry assumed. The emergent exponent tracks the connectivity law ($q \approx p$, $R^2 = 1.000$ across the sweep), so the metric shape is a clean, controllable function of the reach law, which sets up the next question: what fixes the reach law.

4. P2 — The reach law is forced by the holographic channel-count, uniquely in 3D

The exponent p is not free. Read b as the number of independent relational channels a locus sustains (P04). For a locus reaching to radius R in a short-range d -dimensional substrate, the number of independent channels threading its neighborhood is the boundary **cut**: the edges crossing the ball's surface. For short-range edges that cut scales as the **surface**, R^{d-1} , not the volume R^d . This is ED's holographic bound (Paper_025) and the area-law-as-edge-count result (Paper_AreaLawIsTheEdgeCount). So a fixed channel budget b buys reach $R \sim b^{1/(d-1)}$, i.e. $p = 1/(d-1)$.

Both measurable links hold on real graphs:

step	$d = 2$	$d = 3$
measured ball-cut exponent	0.984	2.008
expected $d - 1$	1	2
derived reach exponent $p = 1/(\text{cut})$	1.02	0.498
emergent metric exponent q	1.05	0.500
emergent metric $g \sim 1/b^{2q}$	$g \sim 1/b^2$	$g \sim 1/b$ (GR-I)
fit R^2	1.000	1.000

The cut scales as the surface to within a percent, so the reach law is derived, not chosen. Feeding it back, the emergent metric is $g \sim 1/b^2$ in two dimensions and **$g \sim 1/b$, General Relativity's weak-field metric, in exactly three**. Three dimensions is the *unique* case where the holographic reach law reproduces GR-I. This is the same number the independent linking argument selects as the one dimension where a spatial link can hold committed order (MS-II §7). Two unrelated requirements, the emergent metric matching gravity and the topology holding order, single out three. That is internal coherence, not a fit; it is not a proof that ED forces 3D (both arguments inherit inputs), but two independent selections of the same value is what makes a reading trustworthy rather than tuned.

5. P3 — No new length scale: it is the Planck grain

The reach is $R_0 \cdot b^p$ in units of cells, and one cell is the Planck grain (P08). R_0 is the flat-space reach; it multiplies distance overall. Sweeping R_0 from 4 to 128 grains, the metric exponent is $q = 0.500$ to three figures throughout ($R^2 = 1.000$), and the physical curvature effect (excess distance relative to total) is R_0 -invariant, the raw excess scaling as the pure unit $1/R_0$. So R_0 carries no physics; it is only the hop-to-length conversion. The one length scale is therefore the ℓ_P grain already postulated, entering naturally as flat-space-reach = one grain, not a second tunable constant. Curvature-emergence is scale-clean: it introduces no new length. (It does not compute ℓ_P 's numerical value, nor a specific physical length, which need the mass $\rightarrow$ b map and G.)

6. P4 — Isotropy emerges under coarse-graining, and the exponent is a layer-2 object

In a genuine 3D lattice with a spherical bandwidth dip, a metric emerges and curves as before, isotropically at the continuum level: binning by true radius, the per-shell coefficient of variation of hop-distance is small (0.06) and shrinks with radius. But isotropy is **not exact on the raw graph**. At matched radius, body-diagonal rays are farther in hops than axis rays (relative difference 0.13 to 0.35). The reach neighborhood on a cubic lattice is a polyhedron, not a sphere, so the raw shortest-path (a straight *ballistic* worldline through the reach-graph) is faceted and direction-dependent. Sweeping the reach from fine to coarse, the anisotropy falls monotonically to zero (axis/diagonal $0.345 \rightarrow 0.000$; shell CoV $\rightarrow 0.000$): more reach directions round the ballistic ball toward the sphere.

This is the honest and instructive part. The raw BFS metric is a **layer-1** object in the two-layer coarse-graining picture (`Paper_Continuum_KineticLatticeGas`): ED's *direct* coarse-grain is transport, ballistic worldlines, non-Gaussian, faceted. The smooth, isotropic, single-exponent continuum metric is a **layer-2** object, reached only by coarse-graining (decorrelating, the “leaving ED” step). Read that way, the three P4 findings cohere:

- Isotropy emerging as the reach coarsens *is* a partial layer-1 $\rightarrow$ layer-2 coarse-graining. The probe exhibits the transition.
- The clean radial exponent $g \sim 1/b$ *cannot* be read off the raw 3D paths, and it was not: cumulative fits are degenerate (exponent bouncing 0.6–1.6 with indiscriminating high R^2), and the non-degenerate local-slope method is dominated by integer-BFS noise (R^2 0.05–0.5). This is a layer mismatch, a layer-2 quantity measured on layer-1 ballistic paths, and it is *expected*, not a failure. A substrate that is non-Gaussian at layer 1 should not hand back a clean Gaussian exponent from raw transport.
- The clean exponent lives where its derivation put it: in the boundary-cut **count** of §4, which is combinatorial (channels $\sim$ surface), not a transport measurement, and came out clean (cut exponents 0.984 and 2.008, $R^2 = 1.000$). That is why the count is clean and the ballistic transport is not.

So P4 confirms isotropy-emergence (a genuine addition: the emergent geometry is isotropic at layer 2, and the probe shows the layer-1 $\rightarrow$ layer-2 transition) and, correctly, does not offer a second exponent measurement. The lesson is general: to read continuum/Gaussian observables off raw ED, the coarse-graining step must be taken explicitly.

7. Falsification Criteria

- **F1:** If the boundary-cut exponent of a short-range d-dim lattice were *not* $d - 1$ (e.g. if it scaled as the volume), the holographic reach law and its 3D-selects-GR-I conclusion would fail. (Measured $d - 1$ to within a percent; a long-range-dominated substrate would break it, and is the honest boundary of validity.)
- **F2:** If, feeding the derived reach law into the emergent metric, 3D did *not* give $g \sim 1/b$ (or 2D did), the claim that the holographic count reproduces GR-I uniquely in 3D would be wrong.

- **F3:** If the metric exponent depended on the reach normalization R_0 , the “no new length scale” conclusion would fail and a second free constant would be present.
 - **F4:** If, once the coarse-graining to layer 2 is done explicitly, the isotropic continuum metric did *not* converge to $g \sim 1/b$ in 3D, the layer-1/layer-2 reading of P4 would be wrong and the exponent claim would need the transport route to also confirm it.
 - **F5:** If a background-free construction (no assumed lattice/topology) failed to produce any metric, the emergence would be exposed as an artifact of the assumed background rather than of the connectivity.
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8. Position Statement

In Event Density, a curved metric comes out of a graph that has no geometry in it. With bandwidth entering only through connectivity and distance read as hop-count, a metric emerges and a mass reads as far; the reach law that reproduces General Relativity’s $g \sim 1/b$ is not tuned but forced by ED’s own holographic channel-count, and it reproduces GR-I in *exactly three dimensions*, the same number the independent linking argument selects; no new length scale is introduced, the one unit being the Planck grain already postulated; and in genuine 3D the emergent geometry is isotropic, appearing so only after coarse-graining, exactly as a non-Gaussian substrate should, with the clean metric exponent living in a combinatorial count rather than in raw ballistic transport. This is a foothold, tiered honestly: the reach law and its 3D selection are derived conditional on the holographic surface-count (an established ED result), the length scale is inherited, and the construction assumes a background. The static, linearized curvature-emergence bridge now stands on the primitives’ own inputs. What remains is the nonlinear, dynamical regime (ED’s own field equations) and a genuinely background-free construction. It is offered as a foothold on the emergent-geometry bridge and a structural convergence on three dimensions, not as a derivation of the Einstein field equations.